

D645

Crafting a Communications Strategy Through Research and Data Insights

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A communications team at a solar-installation company with a new office in Denver wants to know why homeowners decline its quotes. It reads a national industry report and plans 15 phone interviews with recent non-buyers. The CEO prefers short reports. Which of these is primary research?

- A. The 15 phone interviews
- B. The CEO's preference for short reports
- C. The national industry report
- D. Both, since the team is using both now

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team reads a published government census report to size its audience. What kind of research is this?

- A. Qualitative research
- B. Primary, because the team is reading it for the first time
- C. Primary, if the report is recent
- D. Secondary research

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A museum that recently added a café wants to understand why young adults feel the museum “isn’t for them.” Which method fits best?

- A. Counting ticket sales by age group.
- B. A survey of café customers.
- C. A 1,000-person rating-scale survey.
- D. Focus groups or in-depth interviews with young adults.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team needs to know what percentage of its 20,000 members prefer email versus text messages. Which method fits best?

- A.** Ten in-depth interviews.
- B.** Reading a handful of social media comments.
- C.** A closed-ended survey of a representative sample.
- D.** Three focus groups.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A team at a community health clinic with a new parking lot is building a persona. Research shows many target patients are hourly workers who can't take time off and check their phones on short breaks. Which persona is best?

- A.** A patient who loves the new parking lot.
- B.** Maria, 34, works shifts at a grocery store, checks her phone on 15-minute breaks, needs evening appointments, and worries about lost wages.
- C.** Everyone in the county.
- D.** Adults aged 25 to 54.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An outdoor-apparel brand with 40 stores groups its audience as "people who care about sustainability and value outdoor adventure." The brand recently updated its logo. What type of segmentation is this?

- A.** Behavioral
- B.** Psychographic
- C.** Geographic, because the brand has stores.
- D.** Demographic

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of behavioral segmentation?

- A.** Customers aged 18 to 24.
- B.** Customers who bought in the last 90 days vs. lapsed buyers.
- C.** Customers who value luxury.
- D.** Customers in the Pacific Northwest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A hospital communications team surveys visitors about a new visitor policy by posting a link only on the hospital's Facebook page. It gets 2,000 responses. The page recently got a new red banner. What is the main concern?

- A.** A large sample guarantees accurate results.
- B.** 2,000 responses is too small.
- C.** The sample isn't representative of all visitors.
- D.** The red banner may bias answers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A manufacturer with three plants will close one of them. Employees at that plant, customers, and local media all need to hear the news. The founder's portrait still hangs in the lobby. What is the best sequence?

- A.** Tell affected employees first, or at the same moment as the public announcement.
- B.** Tell customers first to protect sales.
- C.** Issue the press release first, then tell employees.
- D.** Tell only employees and skip external audiences.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A post by a pet-adoption nonprofit that recently moved shelters reached 25,000 users and got 750 engagements. It went out at 9 a.m. with 12 photos. What is its engagement rate by reach?

- A. 3%
- B. 0.03%
- C. 62.5 per photo
- D. 33.3%

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign targets a 4% engagement rate on an expected reach of 18,000. How many engagements are needed?

- A. 4,500
- B. 72
- C. 720
- D. 7,200

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

A communications team at a telecom with 2 million customers wants to use recorded customer call transcripts to build personas. The team lead joined last month. What is the ethical step?

- A. Quote customers by name to make personas feel real.
- B. Let only the new team lead view the transcripts.
- C. Use them freely, since the company owns its data.
- D. Confirm the use fits the privacy policy and consent, and de-identify the transcripts.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A communications team at a solar-installation company ~~with a new office in Denver~~ wants to know why homeowners decline its quotes. It reads a national industry report and plans 15 phone interviews with recent non-buyers. ~~The CEO prefers short reports.~~ Which of these is primary research?

Target word: identify primary **Decides:** The team collects the interview data itself.

A	Correct	Data gathered first-hand for this question.
B	Camouflage	Not research at all.
C	Inverted operation	Collected by others: secondary.
D	Confusion set	Use doesn't change who collected the data.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A team reads a published government census report to size its audience. What kind of research is this?

Target word: classify the source **Decides:** Someone else collected it.

A	Adjacent category	Census data is quantitative, and that's a different distinction.
B	Inverted operation	Primary refers to collecting the data, not reading it.
C	Confusion set	Recency doesn't change who collected it.
D	Correct	Existing data collected by another party.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A museum ~~that recently added a café~~ wants to understand why young adults feel the museum "isn't for them." Which method fits best?

Target word: method for "why" **Decides:** The question is about reasons and feelings.

A	Adjacent category	Shows how many, not why.
B	Camouflage	Wrong audience; café visitors already come in.
C	Confusion set	Measures levels, not the reasons behind them.
D	Correct	Qualitative methods uncover reasons.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A team needs to know what percentage of its 20,000 members prefer email versus text messages. Which method fits best?

Target word: method for "how many" **Decides:** A percentage is needed.

A	Confusion set	Qualitative; can't estimate a population share.
B	Dropped element	Tiny, self-selected, and not measured.
C	Correct	Quantitative methods estimate proportions.
D	Inverted operation	Too few people to estimate a percentage.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A team at a community health clinic ~~with a new parking lot~~ is building a persona. Research shows many target patients are hourly workers who can't take time off and check their phones on short breaks. Which persona is best?

Target word: best persona **Decides:** Specific archetype built from the research.

A	Camouflage	Not grounded in the research findings.
B	Correct	Specific, research-based, and useful for messaging and channel choice.
C	Absolute language	Too broad to guide any message.
D	Adjacent category	A demographic segment, not a persona.

6. Answer B Concept 4

An outdoor-apparel brand ~~with 40 stores~~ groups its audience as “people who care about sustainability and value outdoor adventure.” ~~The brand recently updated its logo.~~ What type of segmentation is this?

Target word: segmentation type **Decides:** Values and lifestyle.

A	Adjacent category	Behavioral is based on actions like purchases.
B	Correct	Based on values and lifestyle.
C	Camouflage	Store count doesn't define the grouping.
D	Confusion set	No age, income, or similar traits.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

Which is an example of behavioral segmentation?

Target word: find behavioral **Decides:** Based on what customers do.

A	Confusion set	Demographic.
B	Correct	Purchase behavior.
C	Inverted operation	Psychographic.
D	Adjacent category	Geographic.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A hospital communications team surveys visitors about a new visitor policy by posting a link only on the hospital's Facebook page. It gets 2,000 responses. ~~The page recently got a new red banner.~~ What is the main concern?

Target word: sampling concern **Decides:** Self-selected Facebook followers only.

A	Absolute language	Size doesn't fix selection bias.
B	Wrong stem number	Size isn't the issue; who responded is.
C	Correct	Only followers who chose to answer were reached.
D	Camouflage	The banner doesn't decide representativeness.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A manufacturer with three plants will close one of them. Employees at that plant, customers, and local media all need to hear the news. ~~The founder's portrait still hangs in the lobby.~~ What is the best sequence?

Target word: sequence **Decides:** Affected employees come first.

A	Correct	Staff shouldn't learn about their jobs from the news.
B	Adjacent category	Still puts employees behind outsiders.
C	Inverted operation	Employees hear it secondhand.
D	Dropped element	Customers and media still need accurate information.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A post by a pet-adoption nonprofit ~~that recently moved shelters~~ reached 25,000 users and got 750 engagements. ~~It went out at 9 a.m. with 12 photos.~~ What is its engagement rate by reach?

Target word: engagement rate **Decides:** $750 / 25,000 \times 100$.

A	Correct	$750 / 25,000 = 0.03 = 3\%$.
B	Dropped element	Forgets to multiply by 100.
C	Camouflage	Photo count doesn't define engagement rate.
D	Inverted operation	Divides reach by engagements.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A campaign targets a 4% engagement rate on an expected reach of 18,000. How many engagements are needed?

Target word: solve for engagements **Decides:** $4\% \times 18,000$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 18,000 by 4.
B	Dropped element	Uses 0.4% instead of 4%.
C	Correct	$0.04 \times 18,000 = 720$.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses 40% instead of 4%.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A communications team at a telecom ~~with 2 million customers~~ wants to use recorded customer call transcripts to build personas. ~~The team lead joined last month.~~ What is the ethical step?

Target word: ethical data use **Decides:** Personal data from customers.

A	Inverted operation	Exposes individuals.
B	Camouflage	Who views them doesn't address consent or identification.
C	Absolute language	Ownership doesn't override consent and privacy.
D	Correct	Protects customers while allowing insight.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Primary vs. secondary research	Primary research is data you collect yourself for this purpose; secondary research uses data others already collected.	Calling any newly read report primary.	Who gathered the data and for what purpose.
2	Qualitative vs. quantitative	Qualitative methods (interviews, focus groups) explain why; quantitative methods (surveys, counts) measure how many.	Using a counting method to learn motives, or a focus group to estimate percentages.	“Why” vs. “what percentage.”
3	Personas	A persona is a research-based, specific archetype with goals, behaviors, constraints, and channels.	Using a demographic range as a persona.	Choosing the best persona from research findings.
4	Audience segmentation	Demographic = who they are; geographic = where; psychographic = values and lifestyle; behavioral = what they do (purchases, usage).	Confusing psychographic and behavioral.	The basis for grouping an audience.
5	Representative samples	A sample must represent the target population; a large self-selected sample is still biased.	Thinking a big sample guarantees accuracy.	How respondents were recruited.
6	Internal before external	Employees directly affected should hear news before or at the same time as the public.	Leading with the press release.	News affecting staff and outside audiences.
7	Engagement rate	Engagement rate by reach = engagements / reach × 100.	Inverting the ratio or dropping the ×100.	Reach and engagement counts.
8	Research ethics and privacy	Use audience data within consent and privacy policy, de-identify personal information, and never expose individuals.	Assuming the company can use data it holds any way it likes.	Customer data being repurposed for research.

Course scope (public description): Crafting a Communications Strategy Through Research and Data Insights prepares learners to develop a strategic communications plan based on data and research. Learners will conduct audience analysis, create a persona, and create internal and external communication strategies to inform their messaging, targeting, and content creation. In this course learners will collaborate with peers to gather insights on audience preferences and behaviors and use this information to shape audience specific communication strategies. As learners develop the ability to harness data and research to make informed decisions, connect with their audience and communicate ethically and effectively, they will address various stakeholder needs to achieve a desired outcome.